



# Mapping Customer Journeys to Features

Week 2 • Day 5 • Strategic Design & Metrics

TPM Academy



## Day 5 Objectives

- Build a **customer journey map** that is grounded in observed evidence, not aspirational fiction
- Surface **non-product touchpoints** (paper, phone, other systems) — the parts most journey maps miss
- Convert friction stars into **3 feature concepts** that link friction → metric → principle
- Defend each feature concept with **trade-offs and validation criteria** — not just upside
- Deliver a **12-minute Week-2 readout** that ties the whole week into one strategy package



# Today's Shape

| Clock         | Block                | Outcome                              |
|---------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------|
| 09:00 – 09:15 | Opening              | Pin all Week-2 artifacts on the wall |
| 09:15 – 10:30 | Block 1 + Activity 1 | Anchor the journey                   |
| 10:45 – 12:00 | Block 2 + Activity 2 | Fill the lanes                       |
| 13:00 – 14:15 | Block 3 + Activity 3 | From friction to features            |
| 14:30 – 16:00 | Block 4 + Readouts   | 12-min Week-2 readouts               |

# Block 1 — What a Journey Map Is

Anchor in evidence before debating fixes

## Is / Is Not

| Is                                                  | Is not                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Timeline of <b>user actions, thoughts, emotions</b> | Flowchart of your product's screens   |
| Grounded in <b>observed + reported</b> behavior     | How you wish people used your product |
| Specific to <b>one persona, one job</b>             | "General user" map                    |
| A tool to find <b>friction</b> and <b>leverage</b>  | An end-state living in a wiki         |

**The TPM job:** not the prettiest map. *Find where friction is highest, then connect those points to features that move metrics.*



# The Five Swim Lanes

1. **Stage** — Phases of the journey (5–8 stages)
2. **Actions** — Concrete verbs the user is doing
3. **Thoughts** — Quotes from interviews where possible
4. **Emotions** — 4-point curve, plotted
5. **Touchpoints** — Every system & person; **star the friction**

**Watch:** the emotions curve must *not* be flat. A flat curve means the triad is sanitizing.

# Pick One Persona, Pick One Scope

## Pre-shift → end-of-shift

A single workday.  
Best for journeys  
where time-of-day  
matters.

## First-30-days

Onboarding-heavy.  
Best for surfacing  
time-to-first-value  
friction.

## Mid-shift exception

"Tech calls out sick."  
The canonical  
disruption. High-  
fidelity friction.

**One persona, one scope.** Not "all users, all situations." That's the difference between strategy and a wishlist.

# Activity 1 — Anchor the Journey

Triads • 35 minutes

Pick one persona, one scope. Stage the journey (5–8 stages). Sanity-check against Week-1 evidence.

- 5 min: confirm persona
- 10 min: pick scope
- 15 min: stage the journey on the canvas
- 5 min: tag any inferred stage



5 persona • 10 scope • 15 stage • 5 evidence-check



# Block 2 — Fill the Lanes

Thoughts, emotions, touchpoints, friction stars



# Non-Product Touchpoints (the part most maps miss)

For every stage, list **every system or person** the user interacts with — including paper, phone, other software, manager, customer.

## ✗ Incomplete map

- Stage: "Reconcile"
- Touchpoint: "FieldPulse mobile"

Misses the actual journey.

## ✓ Honest map

- Stage: "Reconcile"
- Touchpoints: FieldPulse mobile, paper ticket book, tech's phone, owner's spreadsheet, the printer that jammed

Surfaces the integration story.

**Bridge to Week 4:** non-product touchpoints become the input to system-component mapping in Week 4.

## The Friction Star

Place a star on every stage where the user is fighting the journey.

**Friction stars should cluster.** If everything is friction, nothing is.

- 2–3 stages with stars → healthy map
- 5+ stages with stars → you're not discriminating; re-rank by severity
- 0 stages with stars → you sanitized the journey; re-listen to interviews

## Activity 2 — Fill the Lanes

Triads • 40 minutes

Populate Thoughts, Emotions, Touchpoints. Star the friction. Walk-through review by one member.

- 10 min: thoughts (use real interview quotes when possible)
- 10 min: emotions curve (must vary)
- 15 min: touchpoints (include non-product)
- 5 min: walk-through narration



10 thoughts • 10 emo • 15 touch • 5 walk

# Block 3 — From Friction to Features

Three feature concepts that pass the strategy test



# The Three-Test Bar

A feature concept earns a place if it passes **all three**:

| Test           | Question                                                                                                |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Friction link  | Which specific stage and friction does it reduce?                                                       |
| Metric link    | Which operational signal or KPI from your Tier Sheet does it move?                                      |
| Principle link | Which of your 3 design principles does it align with (or which does it deliberately trade off against)? |

**The recurring failure:** features without metric links. Force the link or kill the feature.



# The Feature Card Template

```
## Feature concept: <name>
```

```
</name>
```

```
<strong>Stage(s) addressed:</strong> <journey stages="">  
<strong>Friction reduced:</strong> <specific friction="" starred="" on="" the="" map="">  
<strong>Metric it moves:</strong> <op-signal or="" kpi="">  
<strong>Aligned principle:</strong> <which of the 3>  
<strong>Trade-off / risk:</strong> <what we'd give up; what could go wrong>  
<strong>Validation:</strong> how would we know it actually moved the metric in 30 days?</op-signal></specific></journey>
```

**Trade-off / risk is non-negotiable.** "No downside" is a failed answer. Every choice forecloses another.



# Activity 3 — From Friction to Features

Triads • 40 minutes

Brainstorm 8 candidates. Apply the three-test bar. Cull to 3 with full feature cards.

- 15 min: brainstorm (volume first)
- 15 min: three-test scoring
- 10 min: cull to 3 + complete cards



15 brainstorm • 15 score • 10 cull

# Block 4 — Friday Readouts

The full Week-2 strategy package, 12 minutes



# The 12-Minute Package

| Time  | Section                        | What you cover                              |
|-------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| 1 min | NS + counter-metric            | Statement, segment, number                  |
| 2 min | Tier Sheet causal chain        | Three sentences, op-signal → KPI → NS       |
| 2 min | One design principle in detail | The one with most expected pushback         |
| 4 min | Journey map walk-through       | Persona, scope, friction stars              |
| 3 min | 3 feature concepts             | Each: stage / friction / metric / principle |

**All three voices speak.** No single triad-spokesperson. Engineering judges lecturers harshly.



## Scoring Rubric (Live)

| Dimension           | Weight | Exemplary                                                   |
|---------------------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Metric coherence    | 25%    | Believable causal chain through Tier Sheet                  |
| NS defense          | 20%    | Three pitfall rebuttals named & defended                    |
| Journey realism     | 20%    | References Week-1 evidence; non-product touchpoints present |
| Feature linkage     | 15%    | Each feature ties to journey friction AND a metric          |
| AI-use transparency | 10%    | Provenance log surfaced when relevant                       |
| Design awareness    | 10%    | Principle named with trade-off acknowledged                 |

## Activity 4 — Readouts

Triads • 12 min present + 3 min Q&A each

Assemble the package. Rehearse with the clock. All three voices on stage.

- 15 min: assemble & order artifacts
- 15 min: rehearse with timer
- 5 min: assign speakers
- 10 min: predict the toughest peer challenge



15 assemble · 15 rehearse · 5 speakers · 10 predict



# Week 2 Wrap

## What we built this week

- Defensible North Star + counter-metric
- Refreshed Metrics Tier Sheet
- 3 design principles per triad
- AI-Assembled Strategy Brief with provenance
- Customer journey map + 3 feature concepts

## What opens Week 3

- **Requirements Engineering & Mini-Capstone**
- Convert your top feature concept → full **Technical PRD** (non-AI)
- Acceptance Criteria, NFRs, peer-review cycle
- Mini-capstone delivers Friday Week 3

**Bring to Monday:** All six Week-2 artifacts in shareable form. The journey map and feature cards are direct PRD inputs.

# Questions & Reflection

Where does your map disagree with how your product was designed?